EDENBRIDGE GRAMMAR
BEYOND SCHOOLING

Edenbridge Grammar

Internet Use, Digital Citizenship & Online Creation Policy

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1. Purpose of This Policy

This policy sets out Edenbridge Grammar's approach to internet use, digital citizenship, and online creation across all phases of the school. It exists to ensure that students are able to engage confidently with the digital world in ways that are **safe, responsible, ethical, and educationally meaningful**, while being protected from harm and guided by clear safeguarding expectations.

The school recognises that digital literacy, online research, and creative digital production are no longer optional skills. They are essential for academic success, employability, civic participation, and lifelong learning. As such, Edenbridge Grammar seeks to provide students with **authentic digital experiences**, rather than shielding them entirely from the online world.

At the same time, the school acknowledges that open internet access brings real risks. This policy therefore establishes a **balanced framework** that combines opportunity with protection, freedom with responsibility, and innovation with oversight.

This policy operates alongside, but separately from, the Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy, and must be read in conjunction with it.

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2. Guiding Principles

Internet use and digital learning at Edenbridge Grammar are underpinned by a set of shared principles that guide staff decision-making and daily practice.

The safety and wellbeing of students are always the highest priority. All digital access, tools, and activities must be considered through the lens of student protection, dignity, and emotional wellbeing.

Learning, inquiry, and creativity are actively encouraged. Students are trusted to explore ideas, research independently, and express themselves creatively, provided this takes place within agreed boundaries and under appropriate supervision.

Trust is built through guidance rather than excessive restriction. Staff are expected to teach students *how* to use the internet responsibly, not simply to block access. This includes modelling good practice, having open conversations, and supporting students to develop judgement and self-regulation.

While students are encouraged to take increasing responsibility as they mature, adults retain oversight and accountability at all times. Digital freedom is never absolute, and staff are responsible for monitoring, guiding, and intervening where necessary.

All digital conduct at Edenbridge Grammar is expected to reflect Islamic values and ethical behaviour. Technology is viewed as a responsibility (Amanah) that must be used with respect (Adab), modesty (Haya), and a commitment to beneficial knowledge (Ilm).

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3. Secure Educational Platforms and AI Learning Environments

All students at Edenbridge Grammar are provided with individual, secure log-ins to the school's AI-supported teaching and mentoring platforms, which are used for academic learning, Quests, reflection, and goal setting.

These platforms operate within **closed and protected digital environments**. They are deliberately designed to separate structured learning from open internet use. Within these systems, content is educational, age-appropriate, and aligned with the school's curriculum and values.

Student interactions within AI-supported environments are continuously monitored for safeguarding purposes. Automated systems are in place to identify concerning language, emotional distress, or inappropriate topics. Where alerts are triggered, trained educators review the context and respond appropriately. No safeguarding concern is addressed by technology alone; all decisions involve human judgement.

Open internet browsing is not available within these AI learning environments. This ensures that academic learning and mentoring take place in a focused, protected space, while still allowing students to engage in broader internet use through separate, supervised channels.

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4. Open Internet Access: Learning with Safeguards

Outside of secure AI learning platforms, students may access the wider internet for research, inquiry, collaboration, and creative projects. Edenbridge Grammar intentionally avoids overly restrictive internet policies, recognising that students must learn to navigate real digital environments as part of their education.

To support safe access, the school uses educational web filters and content blocks that restrict age-inappropriate, harmful, or unsafe material. These filters are designed to protect students without unnecessarily limiting access to legitimate learning resources.

Search activity conducted on school systems is monitored and logged, enabling staff to identify patterns of concern and to intervene early if needed. Parental control measures are embedded within the school's digital infrastructure to provide an additional layer of reassurance.

Staff are expected to actively supervise and guide internet use during learning time. Supervision does not mean constant surveillance, but rather purposeful oversight, clear expectations, and timely intervention where learning focus or safety may be compromised.

Crucially, students are taught how to search critically, evaluate sources, recognise bias, and use information ethically. The emphasis is on developing discernment and responsibility, rather than relying solely on technical restriction.

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5. Digital Citizenship and Responsible Use

Edenbridge Grammar places strong emphasis on digital citizenship as a core life skill. Students are expected to understand that their behaviour online carries the same ethical and social responsibilities as their behaviour offline.

Responsible digital use includes engaging with the internet for purposeful learning and creation, communicating respectfully with others, protecting personal and sensitive information, and respecting the rights, dignity, and safety of peers and wider communities.

Students are explicitly taught that online actions have real-world consequences. This includes understanding digital footprints, the permanence of published content, and the impact of words and images on others.

Where misuse occurs, the school prioritises education and guidance over punishment wherever possible. Proportionate consequences may be applied, but the primary aim is to support learning, reflection, and improved decision-making.

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6. Creative Digital Opportunities for Students

Edenbridge Grammar actively encourages students to use digital tools for creative, entrepreneurial, and expressive learning. Digital creation is viewed as a powerful way for students to demonstrate understanding, develop communication skills, and engage authentically with real-world audiences.

Students may be supported to design and publish websites, create podcasts or digital audio projects, produce educational videos or managed YouTube-style content, participate in online collaborations, or share learning through blogs and digital portfolios.

These activities are carefully planned and supervised by staff to ensure they are educationally purposeful, age-appropriate, and aligned with school values. Creativity is encouraged within a framework that prioritises safety, dignity, and responsible self-presentation.

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7. Safeguarding in Online Creation and Publishing

All student-created digital content is subject to clear safeguarding expectations. Students are never permitted to share personal identifying information publicly, including addresses, contact details, or private images.

Any images, videos, or audio recordings featuring students require staff approval and must comply with safeguarding and consent procedures. Platforms used for publishing or sharing content are selected for their moderation features, educational value, and suitability for young people.

Staff oversee online spaces where student work is shared and monitor comments, interactions, and external engagement. Students are explicitly taught about digital footprints, the permanence of online content, and the importance of thoughtful, responsible self-presentation.

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8. Parental Awareness and Partnership

Edenbridge Grammar recognises parents as essential partners in digital safety and digital education. The school is committed to transparency about how internet access is managed, what safeguards and filters are in place, and how creative digital projects are supervised.

Parents are encouraged to reinforce responsible digital behaviour at home and to maintain open communication with the school. Where concerns or alerts arise, the school engages parents in a timely and appropriate manner, always prioritising the child's wellbeing.

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9. Islamic Values and Ethical Digital Conduct

All internet use and digital creation at Edenbridge Grammar are grounded in Islamic values. Students are guided to ensure that their online behaviour reflects respect (Adab) in communication, modesty (Haya) in content and self-presentation, and trust (Amanah) in the responsible use of access and tools.

Digital engagement is framed around the pursuit of beneficial knowledge (Ilm) and accountability for one's words, actions, and influence. Technology is treated not merely as a privilege, but as a responsibility entrusted to students.

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10. Monitoring, Concerns, and Intervention

Staff actively monitor digital activity on school systems and remain alert to potential concerns. When issues arise, they are addressed promptly, proportionately, and with a focus on safeguarding, education, and support.

Serious or repeated misuse may result in temporary restrictions, parental involvement, or further action in line with school procedures. Where concerns relate to student safety or wellbeing, they are managed under the Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy.

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11. Review and Development

This policy is reviewed regularly to ensure it remains responsive to technological developments, emerging digital risks, educational innovation, and feedback from students, staff, and families.

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Edenbridge Grammar is committed to continuously refining its digital practices to ensure they remain safe, relevant, and educationally effective.

Core Principle

At Edenbridge Grammar, students are trusted to explore the digital world **with guidance, values, and care**.

The aim is not to limit potential, but to ensure that learning, creativity, and innovation take place within a framework that protects **safety, dignity, and wellbeing**, while preparing students to navigate the digital world with confidence and integrity.

Approval

Approved by: _____
CEO: _____
Academic Director: _____
Date: _____
Next Review Date: _____